Nadia Brennan-Aziz

Senior Platform Engineer | AWS, Kubernetes, Terraform

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Platform and reliability engineer with experience building and operating AWS and EKS infrastructure, infrastructure as code, internal developer platforms, observability, SLOs, and cost optimisation. Tech lead of a platform team, with a track record of turning platform improvements into adopted, measurable outcomes. Previously supported game backends during launches with more than one million daily players.

CORE SKILLS

Cloud and infrastructure: AWS, EKS, ECS, Kubernetes, Terraform, Crossplane, Helm, Argo CD, Karpenter, AWS Spot
Reliability and observability: Prometheus, Alertmanager, Grafana, Sloth, PagerDuty, SLOs, burn-rate alerts, capacity planning, k6
Development and automation: Go, Python, GitHub Actions, controller-runtime, Backstage (catalog)
Technical leadership: Platform technical leadership, mentoring, collaboration with product leadership

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Tallybrook Ltd | Senior Platform Engineer | 2022-Present

- Tech lead of the platform team, working on the EKS platform, internal developer platform, SLOs, and cost initiatives.
- Built golden-path service templates in Go and Python, Argo CD ApplicationSets, and Crossplane compositions for RDS, SQS, and S3 provisioned through pull requests. Adopted by all 14 product teams; reduced time from new service to production from about two weeks to under one day.
- Replaced cluster-autoscaler managed node groups with Karpenter and introduced Spot instances for stateless workloads with interruption handling, reducing EC2 spend by 38 percent (about GBP 410,000 per year).
- Established SLOs and burn-rate alerts for the 20 most critical services; pages per week fell by about 60 percent, and an error-budget policy was agreed with product leadership.

Brightwater Games | Site Reliability Engineer | 2019-2022

- Operated AWS infrastructure using Terraform and Atlantis, supporting game backends during launches with over one million daily players.
- Replaced Nagios alerting with Prometheus and Alertmanager.
- Led capacity planning for two major launches. k6 load tests simulating 300,000 concurrent players identified a connection-pool limit that was fixed before launch.

SELECTED PROJECT

Kubernetes cleanup controller | Open-source side project | 2024

- Built a small Kubernetes controller in Go using controller-runtime to delete expired preview namespaces; the project has about 120 GitHub stars.

CERTIFICATION

Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA)

LEADERSHIP AND SPEAKING

- Mentored three engineers from backend roles into SRE.
- Speaker, UK DevOps meetup (2024): "SLOs that product managers care about."